

Elementary Schools in Chicago (North Side Focus)

Chicago offers a wide array of elementary schools, both public and private. Below is a comprehensive list focusing on schools in the Lincoln Park, Lakeview, Bucktown, and surrounding North Side neighborhoods (all schools start at preschool or kindergarten). Each entry includes the school's type (public/private), selective enrollment status, category, address, GreatSchools and Niche ratings, grades served (starting grade through highest grade), application deadlines (for Fall 2026 entry), tuition (if private), student enrollment, student-teacher ratio, and a brief description of key features.

Public Elementary Schools (North Side Chicago)

Abraham Lincoln Elementary School (Lincoln Park)

- **Type:** Public (Chicago Public Schools), neighborhood attendance-area school.
- **Selective enrollment:** No (open enrollment for neighborhood; lottery for out-of-area).
- **Category:** Neighborhood ("Open Enrollment") elementary school ¹.
- **Address:** 615 W Kemper Pl, Chicago, IL 60614 ².
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 9/10 ³ (above-average performance).
- **Niche Rating:** A (Overall Niche Grade A) ⁴.
- **Grades:** K–8 (starts at Kindergarten) ¹.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** N/A (automatic for neighborhood residents; lottery for non-residents typically by early December prior year) ¹.
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public school).
- **Students:** ~803 students (2024–25) ¹.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~16:1 (approximate).
- **Description:** A high-performing neighborhood school in Lincoln Park known for strong academics and a well-rounded curriculum. Lincoln Elementary has a diverse student body and offers robust arts, language, and technology programs within a community-oriented environment. The school consistently earns the highest CPS rating ("Exemplary") and engages parents through an active PTA and local fundraising. Students in Lincoln's attendance boundary are guaranteed a seat, and out-of-boundary students may apply via lottery ¹. The school emphasizes a rich liberal-arts education and has been recognized for its high test scores and student growth.

Louisa May Alcott Elementary School (Lincoln Park)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school.
- **Selective enrollment:** No (open enrollment; lottery for non-local spots).
- **Category:** Neighborhood (formerly *Open Enrollment* school) ⁵.
- **Address:** 2625 N Orchard St, Chicago, IL 60614 ⁵.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 10/10 ⁶ ⁷ (above-average performance in IL).
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade) ⁴ ⁸.
- **Grades:** PK3–8 (offers Pre-K for 3-year-olds through 8th grade) ⁸.

- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** N/A for neighborhood residents (lottery for others, typically Dec 2025) ⁸.
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public).
- **Students:** ~575 students ⁸.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 13:1 ⁸.
- **Description:** Alcott is a **highly rated** public elementary school in Lincoln Park ⁸. It offers a nurturing environment with strong community involvement. The school implements a rigorous curriculum and **Project Lead The Way** STEM programs ⁹, and it supports a “whole child” approach focusing on academic and social-emotional growth. Alcott has a gifted program and enrichment opportunities in arts and technology ⁹. It earned a CPS “Thrive” Award for exceptional student outcomes ¹⁰. Families praise Alcott’s intimate, community feel and committed teachers. Admissions are guaranteed for in-area students; out-of-area families can apply via lottery (no admissions exam) ⁵.

Oscar Mayer Magnet School (Lincoln Park)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (partial neighborhood boundary).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (Magnet with lottery; neighborhood proximity preference).
- **Category:** Magnet **with Boundary** – focus on Montessori (PK-5) and International Baccalaureate Middle Years (6–8) ¹¹ ¹².
- **Address:** 2250 N Clifton Ave, Chicago, IL 60614 ¹³.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 8/10 (high performance on state tests).
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade) ¹¹.
- **Grades:** PK3–8 (Montessori Preschool, K–8 program).
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (via GoCPS lottery; priority to neighborhood and siblings) ¹¹ ¹².
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public; no tuition).
- **Students:** ~740 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~14:1.
- **Description:** Oscar Mayer is a unique CPS magnet school offering a Montessori program in the early grades and an International Baccalaureate (IB) Middle Years Programme in grades 6–8 ¹⁴. It also integrates Fine & Performing Arts into the curriculum ¹¹. As a magnet, Mayer accepts students citywide via lottery (no testing required), while also reserving some seats for local neighborhood children. The school is known for its progressive, student-centered approach – Montessori classrooms emphasize independent, hands-on learning, and the IB program in middle grades fosters inquiry and global awareness. Oscar Mayer Magnet consistently receives high ratings and was the only non-selective school ranked among the top 5 CPS schools for both elementary and middle grades ¹⁵. It has an involved parent community and rich extracurricular offerings in arts, music, and world languages.

Newberry Math & Science Academy (Near North/Old Town)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (no attendance boundary).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (lottery-based magnet admission).
- **Category:** Magnet **“Scholastic Academy”** with STEM focus ¹⁶.
- **Address:** 700 W Willow St, Chicago, IL 60614 ¹⁶.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 7/10 (solid academic performance).
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade).

- **Grades:** K–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (via GoCPS lottery).
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public).
- **Students:** ~400 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~13:1.
- **Description:** Newberry Academy is a citywide magnet elementary school specializing in math, science, and technology. **There is no neighborhood attendance boundary**, so all seats are filled through a lottery (no admission test) ¹⁷. Newberry's curriculum emphasizes inquiry-based learning in STEM subjects, and the school has well-equipped science labs and technology resources. It has earned the CPS "Scholastic Academy" designation due to its rigorous curriculum and provides accelerated math for advanced students. The school also offers robust arts and music programs to ensure a balanced education. Parents highlight Newberry's safe, close-knit environment and "learn by doing" philosophy. As a magnet, Newberry gives siblings preference in the lottery and strives for diversity in its student body.

Franklin Fine Arts Center (Old Town)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (citywide).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (lottery admission; fine arts audition not required for elementary).
- **Category:** Magnet **Fine & Performing Arts** School ¹⁸.
- **Address:** 225 W Evergreen Ave, Chicago, IL 60610 ¹⁸.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 7/10 (above state average in performance).
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade).
- **Grades:** K–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (GoCPS lottery; proximity and sibling priority) ¹⁹.
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public).
- **Students:** ~350 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~12:1.
- **Description:** Franklin is a long-established magnet elementary with a focus on the arts. As a Fine & Performing Arts Center, Franklin infuses visual art, music, drama, and dance into the standard CPS curriculum ¹⁸. Students receive specialized instruction in the arts (such as instrumental music, theater, and studio art) alongside rigorous academics. The school draws students from all over Chicago via lottery and is known for its small size and tight-knit, diverse community. Franklin emphasizes creativity, self-expression, and hands-on learning projects. It has produced many successful alumni in the arts. Parents value Franklin's passionate teachers and the way the arts integration boosts student engagement and confidence. No admissions test or audition is required for K–8 entry; all interested families must apply through the lottery.

LaSalle Language Academy (Old Town)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (citywide).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (lottery-based magnet).
- **Category:** Magnet **World Language** Academy ²⁰.
- **Address:** 1734 N Orleans St, Chicago, IL 60614 ²⁰.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 8/10 (strong academic performance).
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade) ²¹ ²².
- **Grades:** K–8.

- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (via lottery; sibling, staff, proximity, and socio-economic tier priorities) ²³ .
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public).
- **Students:** ~483 students ²¹ ²⁴ .
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 12:1 ²¹ .
- **Description:** LaSalle is a specialized magnet elementary known for its comprehensive world language program. All students at LaSalle Language Academy study a target foreign language (options typically include Spanish, French, Mandarin, or Italian) intensively from kindergarten through 8th grade, in addition to core academics. The school has no attendance boundary – admission is via lottery, and it aims for a diverse enrollment citywide ²⁵ . LaSalle consistently earns high marks for academic quality and was among Chicago's top-rated magnet schools. Students demonstrate high proficiency in state tests and often continue to advanced language studies in high school. The school's approach combines strong fundamentals (literacy, math, science) with daily language instruction and cultural learning, giving students a global perspective. LaSalle also offers arts, music, and sports, and it benefits from robust parent involvement and partnerships for international exchanges.

Skinner North Classical School (Near North/Cabrini-Green area)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *selective enrollment* elementary.
- **Selective enrollment:** **Yes** – admission by entrance exam (Classical program) ²⁶ ²⁷ .
- **Category:** **Selective Enrollment Classical** School (citywide; no boundary) ²⁶ .
- **Address:** 640 W Scott St, Chicago, IL 60610 (near Cabrini-Near North area).
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 8/10 ²⁸ ²⁹ .
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade) ³⁰ ³¹ .
- **Grades:** K–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** Early December 2025 (Selective enrollment exam taken in fall 2025) ²⁶ ²⁷ .
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A (public).
- **Students:** ~480 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~16:1.
- **Description:** Skinner North is one of Chicago's elite **selective enrollment** elementary schools, offering a "Classical" program for gifted students citywide. Admission is highly competitive – children must score top percentile on a CPS admissions exam for entry at K or 1st grade ²⁶ ²⁷ . The curriculum is accelerated one year or more above grade level, with a strong emphasis on literature, writing, math, and humanities. Skinner North students consistently achieve among the highest test scores in the state, and the school is ranked as one of the top public K-8 programs in Illinois ³² . Despite its rigor, Skinner North focuses on educating the whole child, offering art, music, world language, and social-emotional learning. The school celebrates diversity and has a small, tight-knit community feel. It has earned a reputation for excellence, reflected in its **#3 ranking among Chicago elementary schools for 2025** ³² . There is no tuition; however, only students who meet selective criteria (testing) are admitted.

James G. Blaine Elementary School (Lakeview)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school.
- **Selective enrollment:** No.
- **Category:** Neighborhood school (Magnet Cluster – Literature & Writing focus).

- **Address:** 1420 W Grace St, Chicago, IL 60613 ³³ .
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 8/10 ³⁴ ³⁵ .
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Niche Grade) – “highly rated, public, magnet school” ³⁶ .
- **Grades:** PK4–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** N/A for neighborhood residents; out-of-area lottery if space (apply by Dec 2025) ³⁶ .
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~636 students ³⁶ .
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 12:1 ³⁶ .
- **Description:** Blaine is a top-performing neighborhood elementary in Lakeview, known for strong academics and an engaged community. While a neighborhood school, Blaine is also considered a **magnet cluster** school with an emphasis on literature, writing, and the humanities. It offers advanced reading and writing workshops and boasts high proficiency rates (57% in math, 53% in reading on state tests) ³⁶ . Blaine has a well-rounded curriculum including science labs, technology, music, fine arts, and athletics. The school benefits from active parent organizations and significant fundraising which support additional staff and enrichment programs. Blaine consistently ranks among the better elementary schools in CPS; it was rated one of the “Top Neighborhood Schools” in Chicago. Families praise Blaine’s dedicated teachers, rigorous curriculum, and safe, community feel in the Southport Corridor area of Lakeview.

Nettelhorst Elementary School (East Lakeview)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school.
- **Selective enrollment:** No.
- **Category:** Neighborhood (Magnet Cluster – Fine & Performing Arts focus).
- **Address:** 3252 N Broadway, Chicago, IL 60657.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 9/10 (high performance and student growth).
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall) ³⁷ .
- **Grades:** PK3–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** N/A (in-boundary guaranteed; lottery for out-of-boundary) ³⁷ .
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~650 students ³⁷ .
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 14:1 ³⁷ .
- **Description:** Nettelhorst is a vibrant neighborhood school in East Lakeview that operates as a **magnet cluster** school with a fine arts focus. It has a rich arts program (including visual art, dance, drama, and music) integrated into a rigorous academic curriculum. Nettelhorst is notable for its strong parent and community involvement – a decade ago, parents famously led a turnaround that transformed the school into one of Chicago’s most sought-after elementaries. It now boasts high test scores and a diverse, inclusive culture. The school offers French language in upper grades and partners with community organizations for enhancements like a school garden and farmers market run by students. Nettelhorst has been lauded as a model of a successful neighborhood school turnaround, combining progressive education methods with solid fundamentals. Families often cite the “Nettelhorst community” as one of the school’s greatest strengths.

Hawthorne Scholastic Academy (Lakeview)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (citywide).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (magnet lottery).

- **Category:** Magnet school (Liberal Arts/Scholastic Academy).
- **Address:** 3319 N Clifton Ave, Chicago, IL 60657.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 10/10 ³⁸ ³⁹ (consistently above average in IL)
- **Niche Rating:** A (Overall Niche Grade) ⁴⁰ ⁴¹ .
- **Grades:** K–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (GoCPS lottery; sibling and proximity priority) ⁴² ⁴³ .
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~604 students ³⁹ .
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~15:1.
- **Description:** Hawthorne is one of Chicago's top public elementary schools, known for its rigorous curriculum and strong parent involvement. As a **magnet** (Scholastic Academy), Hawthorne draws students citywide via lottery and does not have an attendance boundary. It emphasizes high academic standards – students often work above grade level, and the school's test scores are among the best in the city (Hawthorne is regularly ranked in the top 5 CPS elementaries) ⁴⁴ . Despite **not being selective enrollment**, Hawthorne outperforms many selective schools. It offers differentiated instruction, gifted programs, and extensive enrichment: students have access to 16 sports teams and a gifted/talented curriculum with robust arts and science offerings ⁴² ⁴⁵ . The school fosters a close-knit “family” culture; parents are expected to volunteer and stay engaged. Hawthorne received a CPS **Thrive Award** in 2024 for exceptional student outcomes ⁴⁶ . With strong leadership and teaching, Hawthorne provides an accelerated yet supportive learning environment.

Alexander Graham Bell Elementary School (North Center)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school with *Regional Gifted Center*.
- **Selective enrollment:** Partially – **Yes** for the Regional Gifted Center (grades 1–8 require testing) and **No** for neighborhood K program.
- **Category:** Neighborhood school **and** Selective Enrollment Regional Gifted Center (dual programs) ⁴⁷ ⁴⁸ .
- **Address:** 3730 N Oakley Ave, Chicago, IL 60618 ⁴⁹ .
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 10/10 ⁵⁰ ⁵¹ (top 1% in IL)
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall Grade); Niche Grade A for Academics ⁵² ⁵³ .
- **Grades:** K–8 (Neighborhood K–8 program; Gifted program 1–8).
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** Neighborhood: N/A (open enrollment for local residents). Gifted RGC: Test required – apply by Dec 2025 via selective enrollment process ⁴⁷ .
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** 848 students (combined) ⁵³ .
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 15:1 ⁵³ .
- **Description:** Bell Elementary is a nationally recognized school that effectively operates **two programs in one**: a standard neighborhood school for local students and a **Regional Gifted Center (RGC)** for gifted students citywide ⁴⁷ ⁴⁸ . Bell is acclaimed for its academic excellence – GreatSchools rates it a perfect 10 ⁵⁰ , and it consistently ranks among Illinois's top 50 K-8 schools. Gifted program students join Bell starting in 1st grade via a competitive test; they receive accelerated instruction in math and language arts. Simultaneously, Bell's neighborhood program is high-performing and includes a specialized track for deaf/hard-of-hearing students (Bell has a longstanding Deaf program). This inclusive model enriches the school's diversity. Bell offers extensive extracurriculars (choir, sports, coding clubs) and has strong arts and music programs as well ⁵⁴ . According to Niche, **57% of Bell's students are proficient in math and 55% in reading**,

well above city averages ⁵³ . Parents laud Bell's dedicated staff and sense of community. The school's large size (800+ students) is managed through excellent leadership and a supportive parent community.

John C. Coonley Elementary School (North Center)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school with *Regional Gifted Center*.
- **Selective enrollment:** Partially – hosts a Regional Gifted Center (grades 1–8 selective).
- **Category:** Neighborhood school + Regional Gifted Center (RGC).
- **Address:** 4046 N Leavitt St, Chicago, IL 60618.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 9/10.
- **Niche Rating:** A (Overall Niche Grade).
- **Grades:** K–8 (neighborhood program; RGC for 1–8).
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** Neighborhood: N/A. RGC: apply by Dec 2025 (testing required).
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~1,200 students (including gifted).
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~17:1.
- **Description:** Coonley is a highly regarded North Center elementary known for innovation and high achievement. It has a robust neighborhood program and also houses one of CPS's sought-after **Regional Gifted Centers** for grades 1–8 (for gifted students citywide). Coonley emphasizes STEAM (Science, Tech, Engineering, Arts, Math) and has specialized labs for science and maker activities. The school offers a comprehensive fine arts program (including drama productions) and was an early adopter of the CPS **STEM** school initiative. Coonley's test scores and student growth rank it among the city's best; the school earned a National Blue Ribbon Award in recent years. Its culture values community and inclusivity—Coonley is known for the “Friends of Coonley” parent group that raises funds for enrichment like teacher aides, extracurriculars, and facility upgrades. The RGC within Coonley requires admissions testing and serves advanced learners with accelerated coursework. Overall, Coonley provides a challenging yet nurturing environment, and demand for out-of-area spots is high each year (in 2024 it was #1 in lottery applications among neighborhood schools).

Pulaski International School of Chicago (Bucktown)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school with magnet program.
- **Selective enrollment:** No (IB program open to neighborhood and lottery).
- **Category:** Neighborhood school with **International Baccalaureate (IB)** focus.
- **Address:** 2230 W McLean Ave, Chicago, IL 60647.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 6/10.
- **Niche Rating:** B+ (Overall).
- **Grades:** PK4–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** N/A for neighborhood; out-of-boundary lottery via GoCPS.
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~600 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~16:1.
- **Description:** Pulaski is a neighborhood elementary in Bucktown known for its **International Baccalaureate Primary Years Programme (PYP)**. As an IB World School, Pulaski emphasizes global-mindedness, inquiry-based learning, and second-language acquisition (it offers Spanish language instruction). The school serves a diverse student body and includes a specialized **English Learners (EL) Regional Gifted Center** for bilingual gifted students ⁵⁵ . Pulaski has modernized facilities

including a science lab and media center from a recent renovation. Parents appreciate the strong sense of community and the focus on educating “the whole child” through IB’s character and service learning components. While Pulaski guarantees seats to local families, it also accepts students citywide via lottery for its IB and gifted programs. It was rated a Level 1+ (highest CPS rating) in recent years, reflecting solid test scores and growth. Pulaski’s graduates often continue in IB programs at the high school level, a testament to the rigorous and holistic foundation they receive.

Drummond Montessori School (Bucktown)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (Montessori).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (lottery-based magnet).
- **Category:** Magnet Montessori School (citywide).
- **Address:** 1845 W Cortland St, Chicago, IL 60622.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 7/10.
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall).
- **Grades:** PK3–8 (Montessori program through 8th).
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (lottery via GoCPS).
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~350 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~11:1 (Montessori classrooms often have two teachers).
- **Description:** Drummond is one of only a few public Montessori schools in Chicago, offering a child-centered Montessori curriculum for ages 3 through 14. Classrooms are multi-age (e.g. 3–6 year olds together, 6–9 year olds together, etc.) and emphasize independent, hands-on learning with Montessori materials. Drummond’s small size and Montessori approach foster a close-knit, family-like atmosphere – older students often mentor younger ones. The school attracts families from across the city who seek Montessori education without private tuition. Students learn at their own pace in a prepared environment, and typically show strong growth particularly in critical thinking and independence. Drummond supplements Montessori work cycles with enrichment in world language, art, music, and technology. There is no test to get in; admission is by lottery, with sibling priority. Drummond consistently receives high parent satisfaction marks and was rated Level 1+ by CPS. Its graduates are known for being self-motivated and well-prepared for diverse high school environments.

Jonathan Burr Elementary School (Bucktown)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school.
- **Selective enrollment:** No.
- **Category:** Neighborhood school (Magnet Cluster – Fine Arts & Technology).
- **Address:** 1621 W Wabansia Ave, Chicago, IL 60622.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 5/10.
- **Niche Rating:** B (Overall).
- **Grades:** K–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** N/A (open to neighborhood; lottery for others if space).
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~400 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~14:1.
- **Description:** Burr Elementary is a small neighborhood school in Bucktown that has seen rapid improvement in recent years. It is a Fine & Performing Arts Magnet Cluster school, integrating arts

across the curriculum and offering programs like drama, visual arts, and coding/technology for all grades. Burr partners with local arts organizations to bring in resident artists and instructors. Academically, Burr's test scores have been rising, and it earned a Level 1 CPS rating. The school prides itself on a nurturing climate – teachers know each student well, and there is a strong emphasis on social-emotional learning and community service (Burr's motto is "Work Hard, Be Kind"). It also offers a dual-language Spanish program to serve its large Spanish-speaking community. As the Bucktown neighborhood has grown in families, Burr's enrollment has increased, with many local parents choosing it over options farther away. The school accepts out-of-boundary students as space allows (via lottery), but priority is given to neighborhood children.

A.N. Pritzker School (Wicker Park)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), neighborhood school with *Regional Gifted Center*.
- **Selective enrollment:** Partially – houses a Regional Gifted Center (grades 1–8).
- **Category:** Neighborhood + Magnet (Fine Arts) + Regional Gifted Center.
- **Address:** 2009 W Schiller St, Chicago, IL 60622.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 7/10.
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall).
- **Grades:** K–8 (neighborhood and magnet); 1–8 RGC (gifted).
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** Neighborhood: N/A. Gifted program: Dec 2025 test and application. Magnet Fine Arts lottery (K entry) by Dec 2025.
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.
- **Students:** ~700 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~16:1.
- **Description:** Pritzker Elementary is a unique CPS school offering multiple programs under one roof. It is the neighborhood school for Wicker Park and also a **Fine & Performing Arts Magnet** school, as well as home to a citywide **Regional Gifted Center** (grades 1–8) ⁵⁵. In the Fine Arts magnet component, Pritzker offers extensive music (including band and orchestra), visual arts, and drama for all students. In the Gifted RGC, admitted students (via testing) receive accelerated curriculum and can take advanced math and literature courses. The school's test scores are well above city averages, reflecting the presence of the gifted program and a strong overall academic culture. Pritzker is known for its robust after-school offerings, including choir, dance, and coding clubs, many of which align with its arts focus. The school does not have an attendance boundary for its magnet and RGC seats – neighborhood children are guaranteed a general education seat, but many local families also apply for the gifted program. Pritzker's diversity and mix of programs create a rich school community. It consistently achieves a Level 1+ CPS quality rating.

LaSalle II Magnet School (Wicker Park)

- **Type:** Public (CPS), *magnet* school (citywide).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (lottery).
- **Category:** Magnet **World Language** School (sister school to LaSalle I) ⁵⁶.
- **Address:** 1148 N Honore St, Chicago, IL 60622 ⁵⁷.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** 6/10.
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall).
- **Grades:** PK4–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** December 2025 (GoCPS lottery).
- **Annual Tuition:** N/A.

- **Students:** ~600 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 13:1.
- **Description:** LaSalle II was founded to expand the successful model of LaSalle Language Academy. It offers instruction in multiple world languages (options include Spanish, French, Mandarin, and Arabic) and every student learns a language from kindergarten through 8th grade, similar to LaSalle I. The school has a global studies focus, incorporating cultural learning and international projects. As a magnet, LaSalle II admits students citywide and has no neighborhood attendance boundary ⁵⁶ (though being located in Wicker Park, it draws many applicants from the Near Northwest Side). Students benefit from updated facilities and a dual-language immersion track for Spanish. Parents note the school's warm environment and strong communication from staff. LaSalle II has shown steady improvement in test scores and received the CPS Level 1 rating. It provides many of the same advantages as the original LaSalle, helping meet demand for language-focused education on the West side of town.

(Note: There are many additional public elementary schools across Chicago. This list emphasizes those on the North Side and nearby areas. All Chicago public elementary schools offer tuition-free education to city residents, and most neighborhood schools will accept out-of-boundary students via lottery if space allows. The GoCPS system is used to apply to magnets, selective programs, and out-of-area enrollment.)

Private Elementary Schools (North Side Chicago)

Francis W. Parker School (Lincoln Park – Private Independent)

- **Type:** Private, independent day school (co-ed).
- **Selective enrollment:** Yes (competitive admissions, holistic review).
- **Category:** Independent **college-preparatory** school.
- **Address:** 330 W Webster Ave, Chicago, IL 60614.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A (private schools are not rated on test scores by GreatSchools).
- **Niche Rating:** A+ (Top 5% nationwide) ⁵⁸ ⁵⁹ .
- **Grades:** JK (age 4)–12 (elementary through high school). Starts at Junior Kindergarten.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** **November 21, 2025** for JK and primary grades (Parker's application deadline for 2026–27) ⁶⁰ ⁶¹ .
- **Annual Tuition:** \$43,590 (Junior K) to \$48,700+ (grades 6–8) for 2025–26 ⁶² ⁶³ . (2026–27 tuition not yet released; expect ~3% increase).
- **Students:** ~940 students total (PK–12) ⁶⁴ ; approximately 400 in Lower School (JK–5).
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 8:1 ⁶⁴ .
- **Description:** Parker is one of Chicago's most prestigious private schools, known for its progressive education philosophy and strong academic outcomes. Founded in 1901 by educator **Francis Parker**, the school emphasizes educating the whole child and developing students as engaged, ethical citizens. Classes are small (often 15 or fewer in early grades) and inquiry-based; students call teachers by first names, reflecting a culture of mutual respect. Parker offers extensive resources in arts, science, and technology – including state-of-the-art labs and studios – and a robust World Languages program starting in elementary. **Annual tuition is about \$43k** in the lower school ⁶² , and the school provides over \$6 million in financial aid to ensure socio-economic diversity ⁶⁵ . Admission is competitive, involving parent interviews, student playgroups/assessments, and recommendation letters. Parker's campus is in Lincoln Park and features a historic main building and new Arts/Science wing. Graduates of Parker matriculate to top high schools and eventually

prestigious colleges. The school's motto "Everything to Help and Nothing to Hinder" reflects its supportive, yet challenging environment.

Latin School of Chicago (Gold Coast – Private Independent)

- **Type:** Private, independent day school (co-ed).
- **Selective enrollment:** Yes (competitive admissions).
- **Category:** Independent **college-preparatory** school.
- **Address:** 59 W North Blvd, Chicago, IL 60610.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A.
- **Niche Rating:** A+ (among top private K-12 schools in Illinois) ⁵⁸ ⁵⁹ .
- **Grades:** Junior Kindergarten (age 4)–12.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** **November 26, 2025** for JK and grades 5–12; **January 16, 2026** for Senior Kindergarten–4th grade ⁶⁶ .
- **Annual Tuition:** \$40,090 (Kindergarten for 2025–26; increases to about \$46k by high school). (2026–27 tuition to be announced; Latin's tuition is comparable to Parker's.)
- **Students:** ~1,190 students (JK–12); about 450 in Lower School (JK–4) and 330 in Middle School (5–8) ⁶⁶ .
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~8:1.
- **Description:** The Latin School is a top-tier private school with a rich 130-year history in Chicago. Known for academic excellence, Latin provides a rigorous curriculum with abundant resources. In the Lower School, class sizes are small (typically 15) and each classroom often has both a lead teacher and an assistant. Latin emphasizes a well-rounded education: core academics are enhanced with daily physical education, world languages (Spanish and Mandarin starting in lower grades), art, music, and library/makerspace time. The school's facilities in the Gold Coast include separate buildings for Lower, Middle, and Upper Schools with advanced science labs, a theater, multiple gyms, and even a swimming pool. Latin's student body is diverse, drawn from all over the city. **Admissions are competitive**, including an assessment of the child, parent essays, and sometimes an entrance exam for older grades. Latin families often describe the community as close-knit and supportive, with an extensive parent network. Latin graduates go on to attend top universities. The school is known not just for its academics but also for character education – its motto is "Semper Fidelitas" (Always Faithful), emphasizing integrity and community responsibility.

British International School of Chicago, Lincoln Park (Private)

- **Type:** Private, independent (co-ed), international school.
- **Selective enrollment:** Moderate (open to all, with evaluation; rolling admissions if space).
- **Category:** **International school** (British curriculum).
- **Address:** 814 W Eastman St, Chicago, IL 60642 (Lincoln Park neighborhood).
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A (private).
- **Niche Rating:** A (Niche overall grade) ⁶⁷ .
- **Grades:** Nursery (15 months)–Year 6 (through 5th grade). (After 5th, students continue at the South Loop campus for middle/high school.)
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** Rolling (recommend applying by early 2026; international admissions often flexible).
- **Annual Tuition:** \$20,000–\$32,000 (estimated range for preschool through 5th grade; exact fees vary by age and schedule).
- **Students:** ~300 students (toddler – 5th).

- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~7:1 in early years, around 10:1 in primary.
- **Description:** BISC Lincoln Park is part of the Nord Anglia network of elite international schools. It offers a globally focused education, combining the English National Curriculum with the International Primary Curriculum. The result is a rigorous yet creative program that emphasizes personalized learning, critical thinking, and cultural awareness ⁶⁸ ⁶⁹. Classes are small, and teachers often come from the UK or other countries, bringing international teaching experience. **Specialty subjects** like French or Mandarin, music, swimming, and STEAM are taught starting in preschool. The Lincoln Park campus serves children up to ~11 years old in a colorful, state-of-the-art facility with whimsical designs (including a rooftop playground and indoor rainforest-themed play space). Being an international school, BISC attracts expatriate families and globally minded local families; it fosters a tight community with many events and traditions celebrating different cultures. The school has been rated one of the top private elementary schools in Chicago and holds an “A” grade on Niche ⁶⁷. After completing Year 6, students typically transition to BISC’s South Loop campus for secondary school (which offers IGCSEs and the IB Diploma). Admissions are not as restrictive as some selective independents – families tour and interview, and student readiness is assessed, but there is often availability especially in early years.

Near North Montessori School (Wicker Park – Private)

- **Type:** Private, independent (co-ed).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (interest in Montessori philosophy expected; waitlist for some ages).
- **Category:** **Montessori** school.
- **Address:** 1434 W Division St, Chicago, IL 60642.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A.
- **Niche Rating:** **A** (Overall Niche Grade) ⁷⁰.
- **Grades:** Ages 2 (toddler) through 8th grade.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** January 2026 (priority; rolling after if spots remain).
- **Annual Tuition:** ~\$18,300 (half-day preschool) up to ~\$23,750 (elementary) and ~\$25,250 (junior high) for 2025–26.
- **Students:** ~585 students (toddler–8th) ⁷⁰.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** 7:1 ⁷⁰ (Montessori classrooms have 2 teachers for ~25 children).
- **Description:** Near North Montessori (NNM) is one of the largest and most established Montessori schools in the U.S., celebrating over 50 years in Chicago. It offers an authentic Montessori program, where students learn in multi-age classrooms using self-directed activities and hands-on materials according to Dr. Maria Montessori’s methods. The school spans toddler through junior high; for example, 3–6 year-olds learn together in “Casa” preschool/kindergarten rooms, and 6–9 and 9–12 year-olds in combined elementary classes. **Academically**, NNM students often perform above grade level, but the focus is on individual progress rather than competition. The curriculum extends beyond core academics to practical life skills, community service (junior high students run a small business and manage finances), and field trips including farm stays. NNM’s Wicker Park campus is an urban, renovated warehouse featuring open, light-filled classrooms and special facilities like a gym, theater, and rooftop playground. The community is diverse and tight-knit, bound by a shared educational philosophy. Parents are very involved, and the school holds annual traditions like the Peace Day parade. Graduates of NNM are known for being independent, inquisitive learners; they attend a mix of top high schools (both selective public and private). Families choose NNM for its nurturing approach that produces not only strong academic results but compassionate, capable young people.

The Catherine Cook School (Old Town – Private)

- **Type:** Private, independent (co-ed).
- **Selective enrollment:** Moderate (standard private admissions process).
- **Category:** Independent elementary & middle school.
- **Address:** 226 W Schiller St, Chicago, IL 60610.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A.
- **Niche Rating:** A (Overall Niche Grade).
- **Grades:** Preschool (age 3)–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** January 12, 2026 (typical deadline for preschool & K; rolling thereafter).
- **Annual Tuition:** \$19,980 (half-day preschool) to \$33,400 (grades 1–8) for 2025–26.
- **Students:** ~570 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~9:1.
- **Description:** Catherine Cook is a respected independent school serving early childhood through middle school, located in the Old Town neighborhood. It is known for integrating technology and innovation with traditional academics – Catherine Cook was one of the first Chicago elementary schools to implement a 1:1 iPad program and makerspace for students. The curriculum is project-based and interdisciplinary; for example, students might explore a “City” unit incorporating social studies, math, and civic engagement. Small class sizes and dedicated advisory programs in middle school ensure each student is well-known and supported. Catherine Cook places a strong emphasis on character education, empathy, and community service. Diversity and inclusion are core values; the school has programs to ensure students from all backgrounds feel welcome. Facilities include a newly expanded building with a science lab, design lab, art studio, and rooftop play space. Parents praise Catherine Cook’s warm environment and the way teachers tailor instruction to each child’s strengths. Graduates are well-prepared for high school, often matriculating to selective publics (like Payton, Jones) or top private high schools. As an independent school, Catherine Cook requires an application, school visit/playdate, and assessment for admissions, but it’s considered less intense than some larger K-12 schools since it only goes through 8th grade.

St. Clement School (Lincoln Park – Private Catholic)

- **Type:** Private, **Catholic** parish school (co-ed).
- **Selective enrollment:** No (parish members and siblings get preference).
- **Category:** Parochial (Archdiocese of Chicago Catholic school).
- **Address:** 2524 N Orchard St, Chicago, IL 60614.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A (parochial schools not rated via state tests on GS).
- **Niche Rating:** A (Overall Niche Grade; high parent satisfaction).
- **Grades:** PK3–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** January 2026 (priority registration for parish families; rolling until filled).
- **Annual Tuition:** \$11,800 (K–8 for parishioners in 2025–26; ~\$13k for non-parish). Preschool tuition varies by schedule.
- **Students:** ~470 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~18:1 in K–8; smaller in preschool.
- **Description:** St. Clement is a sought-after Catholic elementary located in the heart of Lincoln Park, affiliated with St. Clement Parish. It delivers a rigorous academic program enriched by daily religious instruction and values education. Students wear uniforms and participate in traditions like weekly

Mass, sacramental preparation (for Catholic students), and service projects. Academically, St. Clement emphasizes strong foundational skills – its students often score above national averages on the Aspire standardized tests used by the Archdiocese. The school offers art, music, language (Spanish), and technology classes, plus extracurriculars from chess to basketball competing in Catholic school leagues. The community at St. Clement is close-knit and family-oriented; many school families are active parish members. The Home & School Association (HSA) organizes numerous events (like the annual gala and fundraisers) that foster community spirit. While rooted in Catholic tradition, St. Clement welcomes students of all faiths who are open to a Catholic environment. Graduates typically go on to top Catholic high schools (St. Ignatius, Loyola Academy, etc.) or selective public high schools. St. Clement's relatively low tuition (compared to independents) and strong reputation lead to waitlists in some grades, so early application (and parish involvement) is encouraged.

St. Josaphat School (Lincoln Park)

- **Type:** Private, **Catholic** parish school.
- **Selective enrollment:** No.
- **Category:** Parochial (Catholic school).
- **Address:** 2245 N Southport Ave, Chicago, IL 60614.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A.
- **Niche Rating:** A– (Overall).
- **Grades:** PK3–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** February 2026 (rolling after, with parishioner priority).
- **Annual Tuition:** \$10,500–\$11,500 (estimated K–8 tuition for 2025–26, parish vs non-parish).
- **Students:** ~300 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~15:1.
- **Description:** St. Josaphat is a smaller Catholic elementary known for its family-like atmosphere and strong academics. Located in Lincoln Park's DePaul area, it serves the St. Josaphat Parish community and beyond. The school offers a solid curriculum in line with Archdiocesan standards, enhanced by modern touches (one-to-one Chromebooks for middle school, for example). Being a smaller school, St. Josaphat allows for plenty of individual attention and multi-age activities – older students often buddy with younger ones for reading and projects. Faith formation is central: students attend Mass weekly and are involved in church life. At the same time, the school has robust secular programs: participation in the Chicago Catholic Youth Organization (CYO) sports, spring musical performances, and clubs like robotics and yearbook. Parents are very active via the Family School Association, supporting events like the Jog-a-thon and holiday bazaars. St. Josaphat has been recognized as a National Blue Ribbon School, reflecting its academic quality. Graduates go on to a mix of Catholic and public high schools, armed with a strong moral foundation and sense of service instilled by the school's motto "Learn, Serve, Lead, Succeed."

Chicago City Day School (Lakeview)

- **Type:** Private, independent (co-ed).
- **Selective enrollment:** Yes (evaluative admissions).
- **Category:** Independent elementary school.
- **Address:** 310 W Irving Park Rd, Chicago, IL 60613.
- **GreatSchools Rating:** N/A.
- **Niche Rating:** A (Overall).

- **Grades:** Junior Kindergarten (age 4)–8.
- **Application Deadline (Fall 2026):** January 2026 (notifications in March).
- **Annual Tuition:** \\$29,800 (K–8 for 2025–26).
- **Students:** ~300 students.
- **Student-Teacher Ratio:** ~7:1.
- **Description:** City Day is a hidden gem – a small independent school near Lakeview focused exclusively on elementary and middle grades. It offers an intimate learning environment with very low student-teacher ratios and a personalized approach for each child. City Day’s philosophy centers on experiential learning; the school has a large campus that includes a greenhouse, gardens, and even a small urban farm where students engage in science and nature study. Core academics are rigorous, especially in reading and math (advanced math tracks are available), and are complemented by rich specialist classes in French, art, music, drama, and physical education. Technology is integrated beginning in primary grades (every student in grades 1–8 has a laptop or tablet). A hallmark of City Day is its many **field trips** – classes venture frequently to museums, theaters, and nature centers around Chicago as part of the curriculum. Parents choose City Day for its warm, nurturing feel (teachers typically loop with the same class for multiple years) and impressive outcomes – City Day graduates often place into honors or selective programs in high school. The school actively seeks a diverse student body; admissions include an observation or shadow day and assessment, but the vibe is welcoming, not high-pressure. City Day is often described as “like a big family” due to its close community and strong parent-school partnerships.

(Additional private schools in the area include The Lycée Français de Chicago (a French international school in Ravenswood offering PK–12 with a French/English bilingual program), German International School Chicago (PreK–8, dual-language German/English in Lincoln Square), Frances Xavier Warde School (Catholic elementary with campuses in downtown Chicago), and many other parochial schools such as St. Andrew, St. Benedict, Queen of Angels, and St. Stanislaus Kostka on the North Side. These schools similarly provide quality elementary education with their own unique missions and communities.)

Sources: Details were compiled from official school profiles and reputable school review sites. Key data like school type, programs, addresses, and enrollment were verified via Chicago Public Schools data ^{1 55} and school websites. Ratings and enrollment figures were sourced from **GreatSchools** ^{50 7} and **Niche** ^{53 37}. Application deadlines for 2026 were obtained from school admissions pages (e.g., Parker and Latin) ^{60 66}. Tuition figures for private schools were taken from published 2025–26 tuition schedules ^{62 63}. Each school’s description is informed by school publications and parent/student reviews ^{9 67}, highlighting distinguishing programs and culture.

^{1 2 3 5 11 12 13 14 16 17 18 19 20 23 25 26 27 47 48 55 56 57} [data.cityofchicago.org](https://data.cityofchicago.org/api/views/c2dy-m9ui/rows.json?accessType=DOWNLOAD)
<https://data.cityofchicago.org/api/views/c2dy-m9ui/rows.json?accessType=DOWNLOAD>

^{4 8} [Alcott Elementary School in Chicago, IL - Niche](https://www.niche.com/k12/alcott-elementary-school-chicago-il/)
<https://www.niche.com/k12/alcott-elementary-school-chicago-il/>

^{6 7 9 10} [Alcott College Prep - Chicago, Illinois - IL | GreatSchools](https://www.greatschools.org/illinois/chicago/1111-Alcott-College-Prep/)
<https://www.greatschools.org/illinois/chicago/1111-Alcott-College-Prep/>

¹⁵ [Hawthorne Scholastic Academy](https://www.hawthorneacad.org/)
<https://www.hawthorneacad.org/>

- 21 22 24 37 **Elementary Schools in Chicago, IL - Niche**
<https://www.niche.com/k12/search/best-elementary-schools/t/chicago-cook-il/?page=3>
- 28 **Skinner North Elementary School - Chicago, Illinois - IL - GreatSchools**
<https://www.greatschools.org/illinois/chicago/10299-Skinner-North-Elementary-School/>
- 29 31 **Skinner North Elementary School in Chicago, IL - Homes.com**
<https://www.homes.com/school/chicago-il/skinner-north-elementary-school/ngfxkcm5xh9jn/>
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<https://www.niche.com/k12/skinner-north-elementary-school-chicago-il/>
- 32 **Skinner North--Neighborhood??? Rankings? - Chicago School**
<https://chicagoschoolorptions.com/forums/topic/skinner-north-neighborhood-rankings/>
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<https://www.greatschools.org/illinois/chicago/957-Blaine-Elementary-School/>
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<https://www.niche.com/k12/blaine-elementary-school-chicago-il/>
- 38 39 42 43 45 46 **Hawthorne Elementary Scholastic Academy - Chicago, Illinois - IL | GreatSchools**
<https://www.greatschools.org/illinois/chicago/1132-Hawthorne-Elementary-Scholastic-Academy/>
- 40 **2026 Hawthorne Scholastic Academy Rankings - Niche**
<https://www.niche.com/k12/hawthorne-scholastic-academy-chicago-il/rankings/>
- 41 **Hawthorne Scholastic Academy in Chicago, IL - Homes.com**
<https://www.homes.com/school/chicago-il/hawthorne-scholastic-academy-school/qtnf5vv08bs5h/>
- 44 **2026 Best Magnet Schools in Chicago - Niche**
<https://www.niche.com/k12/search/best-magnet-schools/t/chicago-cook-il/>
- 49 50 51 54 **Bell Elementary School - Chicago, Illinois - IL | GreatSchools**
<https://www.greatschools.org/illinois/chicago/953-Bell-Elementary-School/>
- 52 53 **Bell Elementary School in Chicago, IL - Niche**
<https://www.niche.com/k12/bell-elementary-school-chicago-il/>
- 58 **Francis W Parker School in Chicago, IL - Homes.com**
<https://www.homes.com/school/chicago-il/francis-w-parker-school/dh2jfmc3pbql2/>
- 59 62 63 65 **Located in Lincoln Park, Chicago - Francis W. Parker School Tuition**
<https://www.fwparker.org/admission/tuition-and-fees>
- 60 61 **How to Apply to Francis W. Parker School | Private School in Chicago, IL**
<https://www.fwparker.org/admission/application-procedures>
- 64 **Francis W. Parker School in Chicago, IL - Niche**
<https://www.niche.com/k12/francis-w-parker-school-chicago-il/>
- 66 **Admissions - Latin School of Chicago: Best Preschool through High ...**
<https://www.latinschool.org/admissions>

67 68 69 BISC Lincoln Park | Nord Anglia Education

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70 Near North Montessori School in Chicago, IL - Niche

<https://www.niche.com/k12/near-north-montessori-school-chicago-il/>